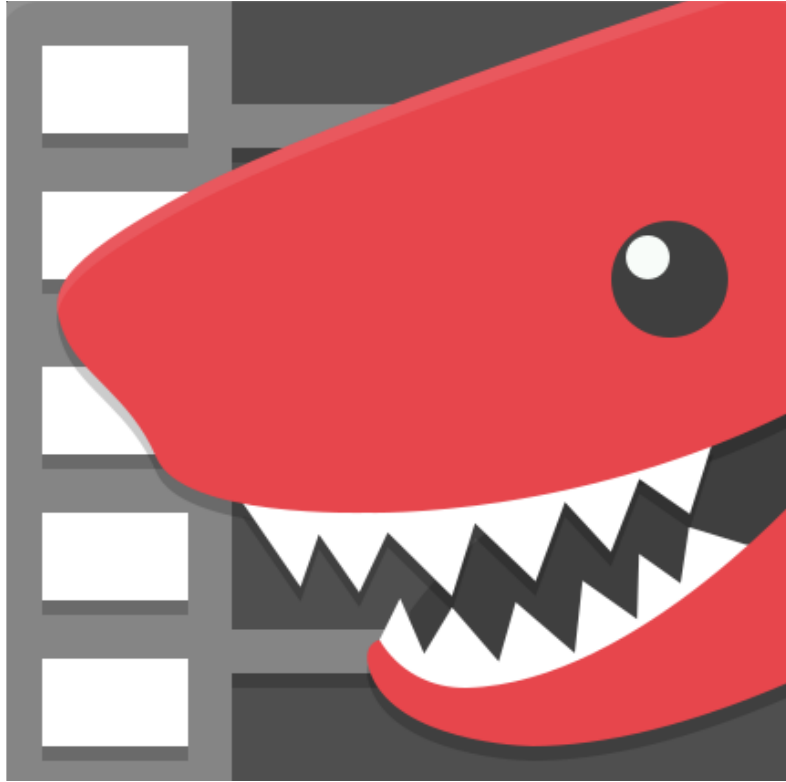




LightWorks Editing Guide

Getting started guide

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Introduction

Welcome to LightWorks! LightWorks is a free* video-editing software featuring advanced editing and mastering capabilities. The purpose of this document is to guide design students through a set process of essential tasks using the LightWorks interface. As you go through the instructions, you will learn how to:

1. Install and activate LightWorks onto your computer
2. Import and trim video and audio
3. Edit media
4. Export content

While the possibilities with LightWorks are endless, these instructions will provide a basic overview on how to use the LightWorks interface. Using this guide, you will understand how to complete a given process and use essential tools in the interface. Because the guide is organized based on essential tasks, you will be able to navigate to any portion of the guide without having to first understand another process or feature.

Before we begin, let's get LightWorks set up on your computer.

Installation and Activation

This section will describe how to install and activate LightWorks onto your computer.

Creating your account

Visit LightWorks ([Click Here to go to the main page](#)) to create and register your account. LightWorks offers a free version so you won't have to pay a monthly subscription fee.

Fill in your personal details and check your email for an activation code.

- Follow the instructions on how to proceed with your software activation.

Select your operating system and click the download button below:

NOTE: *You will need the latest version of QuickTime to start LightWorks*

Windows installation guide

1. On the LightWorks page, go to downloads, navigate to Windows, and download the version best suited for your Windows desktop (either 32-bit or 64-bit).
2. Run the .exe file and complete the install wizard prompt:
 - Ensure all the components are selected for install.
 - Accept the default path, unless you have a specific location you'd like to install.
 - Assign a machine number between 1 and 2703.

NOTE: If you are using LightWorks within a shared network, each machine number should be unique. As a standalone, you can choose any value.

3. When the installation is complete, restart your computer.
4. Start LightWorks and get your software activated.
 - Enter your details into the “Welcome” panel. Your project browser screen will appear.
5. Your LightWorks software is set up and registered.

Mac installation guide

1. On the LightWorks page, go to downloads, navigate to Mac, and click on “Download DMG.”
2. Open the .dmg file to run the file.
3. You will be asked to drag and drop LightWorks into the Application folder.
4. Select LightWorks to get started.

NOTE: You may be prompted with a warning before starting LightWorks. Select “Open anyway” or navigate to your system preferences to accept file *permissions*.

5. Start LightWorks and get your software activated.
6. Enter your details into the “Welcome” panel and your project browser screen will appear.
7. Your LightWorks software is set up and registered.

Linux installation guide

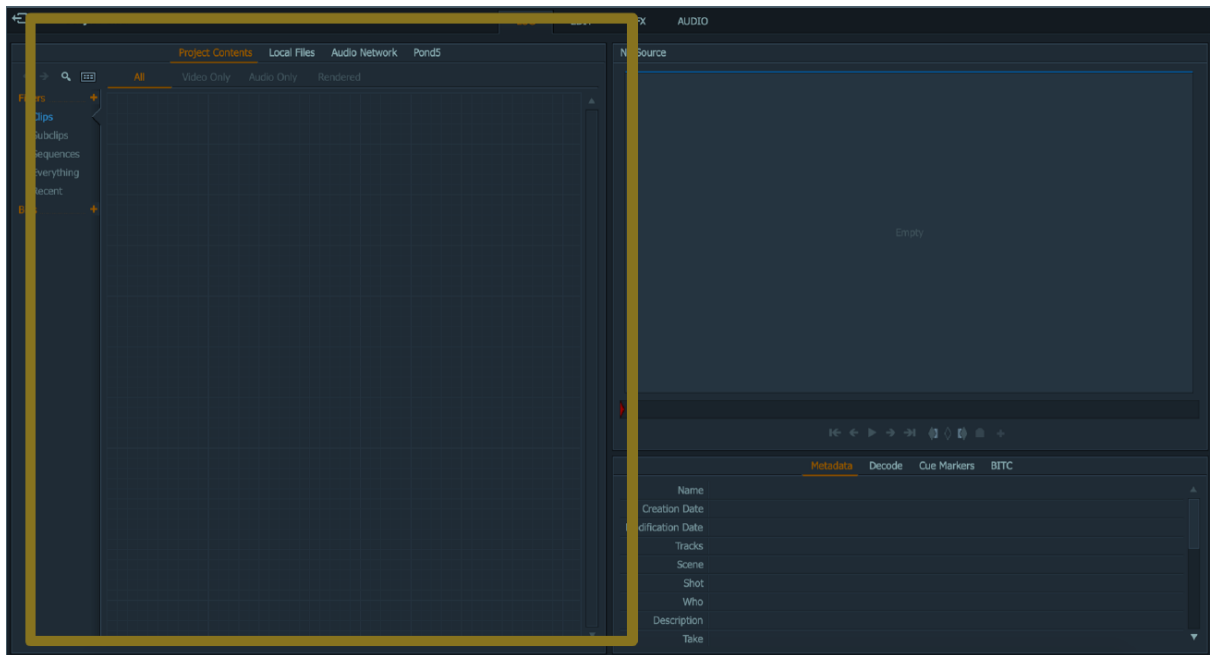
1. On the LightWorks page, go to downloads, navigate to Linux, and click on Download deb or rpm.
2. Open the file on your desktop and enter your password, if required.
3. Start LightWorks and get your software activated.
4. Enter your details into the “Welcome” panel and your project browser screen will appear.
5. Your LightWorks software is set up and registered.

Basic Editing

In this section, you will learn how to create a project, import files, stitch video and audio clips together, add video and audio effects, and export your project. While this section will not go into detail about editing, effects, and content management, you will have a basic understanding of how to use and navigate LightWorks to edit and export a video.

Importing Content

1. On the home page, select “Create a new project” in the top left.
2. The “New project details” will pop-up on your screen:
 - a. Enter the name for your project and select a frame rate.
 - o If you’re not sure what frame rate to use, select “Auto.”
 - b. Click “Create” when you’re ready.
3. From the project contents panel (highlighted on the left, you will be managing all of your media.



4. Navigate to the “Local Files” tab and browse for your .mov or audio file:
 - a. Click on the “Places” drop-down to navigate to different files or folders on your computer.
 - b. Select multiple files by clicking shift or control when selecting each file.
5. When you’ve selected the files you want to use, click the “Import” button in the bottom left of the panel.
 - o All your files will appear in the “Log” tab.

Cutting and editing clips

1. Navigate to the “Edit” tab at the top of the page.
2. From the edit page, select a video or audio clip and double-click to begin editing.

TIP: You can also drag and drop clips into the source viewer.

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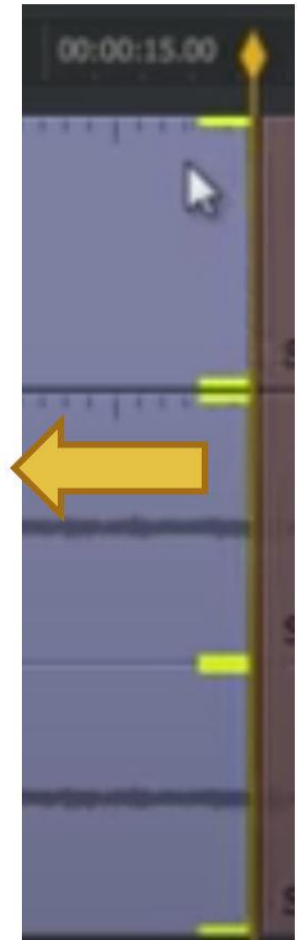
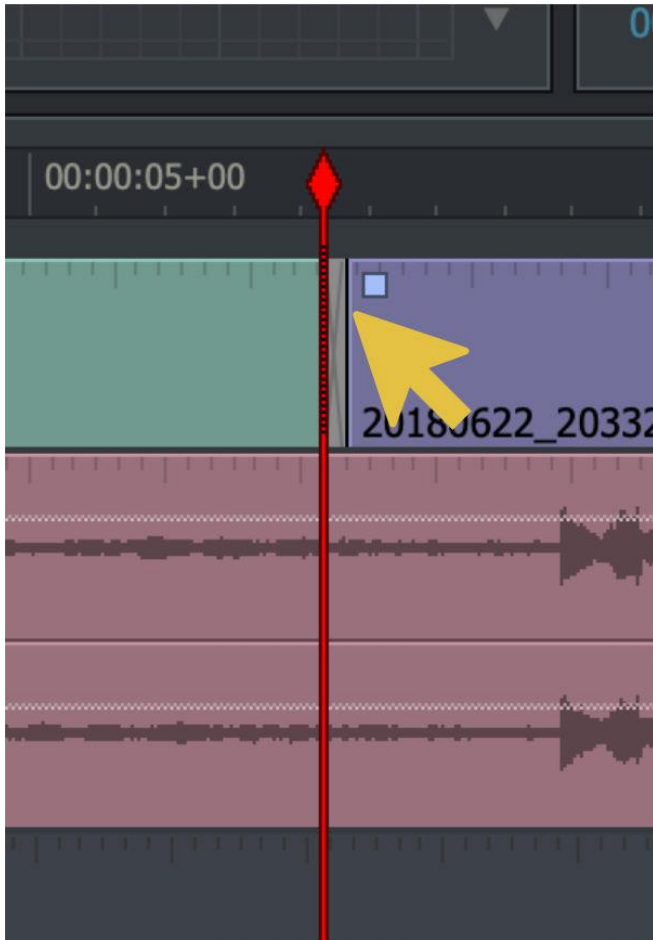
3. Once you select your video clip, it will appear in the source viewer panel; the screen on the far-right is your sequence viewer.



- a. The sequence viewer will display the clips and audio inserted in the timeline.
 - b. To begin cutting your video clip, move the red diamond to the start of the clip section you would like .
4. Once at the correct time, we will need to mark the section:
 - a. Click on the blue diamond pointing left to mark the current position, then click the “play” triangle.
 - b. Once you get to the endpoint of the section you would like to clip, press the square “pause” button and click on the blue diamond pointing right to mark the endpoint.
 5. To send your marked points to the timeline, select the **double-facing arrows** to **insert** the clip into the target sequence.
 - o The **down-facing arrow** will **replace** your content from your sequence in the timeline below with the clip you marked.
 6. As you continue marking and adding clips, adjust the red time marker to the location on the timeline where you want to insert or replace a clip.
 - o To close the empty space at the end of your timeline, right-click in the area you want to remove and select “Close gap” from the menu.
 7. You can also quickly delete, trim, and slide clips by right-clicking on your clip in the timeline to view the pop-up menu.

Trimming

1. Begin trimming your clips by adjusting your cut points.
2. In the timeline panel, adjust the red time marker to the point where you’d like to trim.
 - a. Hover over the left side of the white highlighted cut points in between clips, click and hold, then drag.

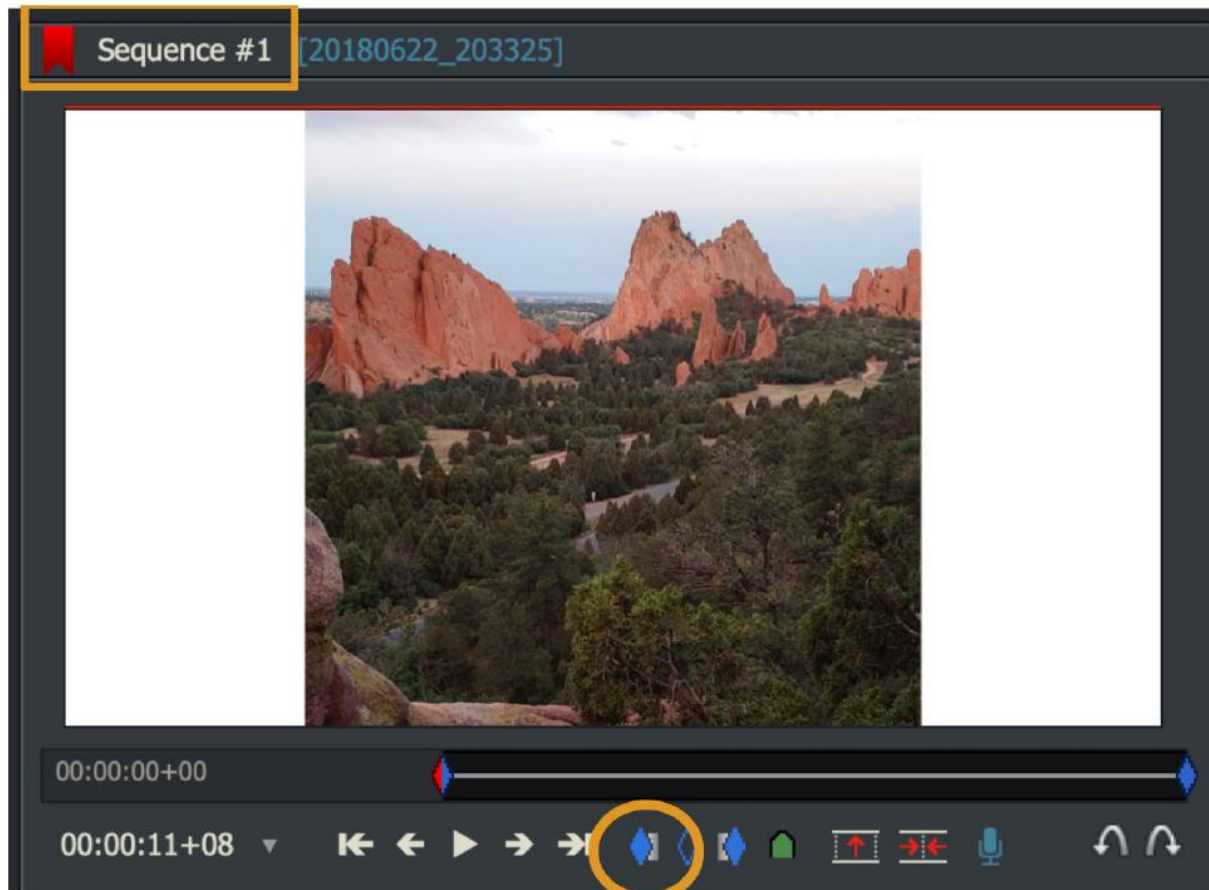


3. This can also be done by right-clicking on the clip and selecting “Slip” in the pop-up menu.
 - a. Drag media left/right to adjust video or audio to the position you indicated with the red time marker.

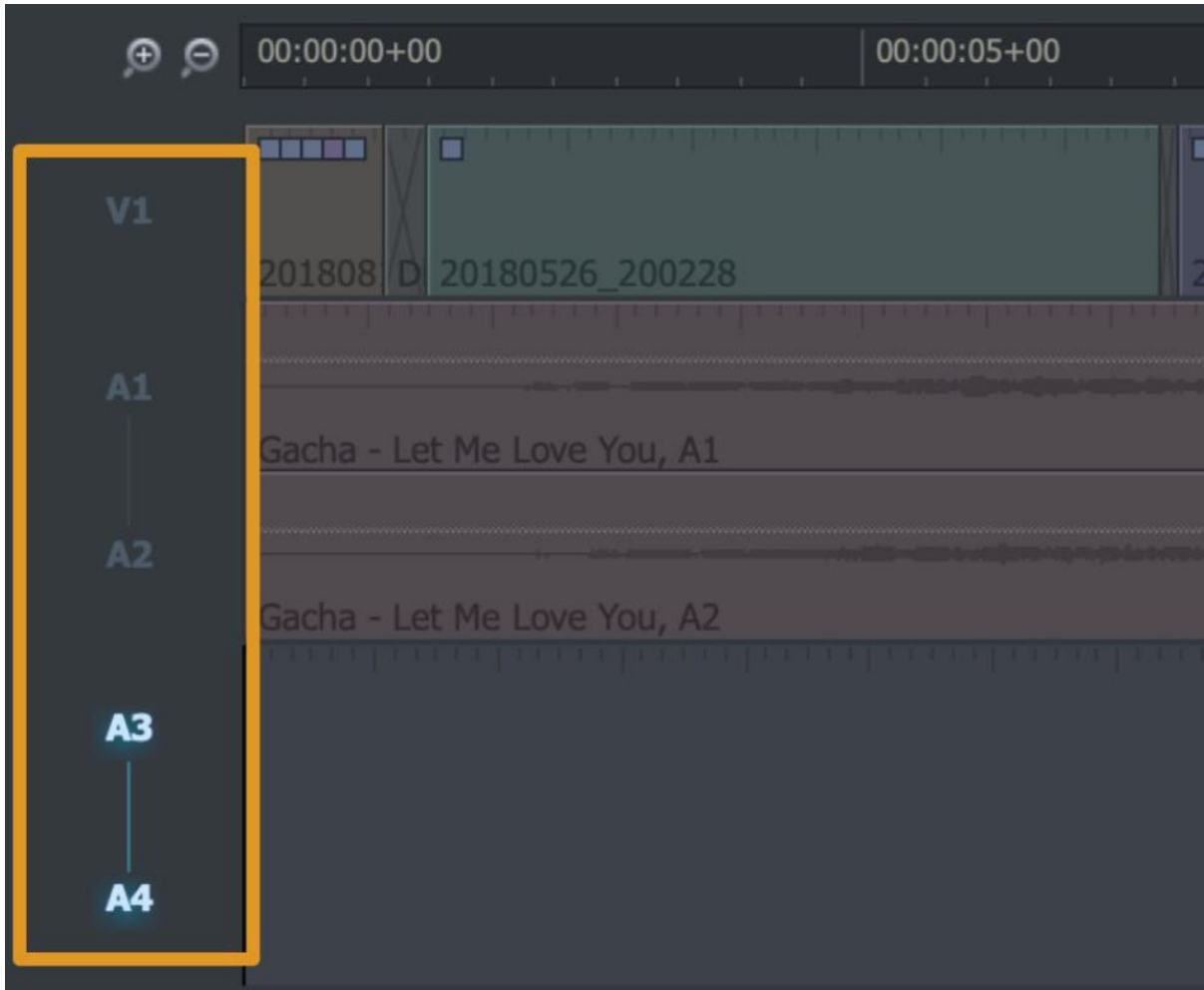
Adding audio

1. Navigate to the “Log” tab and import your audio file using the “Local Files” tab from the project contents panel.
2. Navigate to the “Edit” tab and double click on your audio file to make it appear in the source viewer panel.
3. Move the red time marker in the timeline panel to the position where you’d like your audio to begin playing.
 - a. Mark the start point with left-facing blue diamond in the **sequence viewer** panel.

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- b. Turn off all tracks apart from A1, A2, or A3 (depending on how many video clips were added to your sequence) by clicking on the letters on the left-hand side.



- c. Click on the “Replace” button (blue down-facing arrow) from the source viewer panel on the right.

Editing Audio

1. Begin by accessing the audio key-framing by pressing and holding shift on your keyboard.
2. To adjust the volume of the audio inserted, click on the white line that appears in your audio track.
 - Continue holding shift and drag the line down/up to adjust the volume accordingly.
3. To fade in/out audio, go to the beginning or end of the audio track in the timeline.
 - Click on the top left/right corner and drag the grey triangle towards the middle.

Transitions

1. Add transitions in between video clips by hovering over the white highlighted cut points then right-clicking to bring up the pop-up menu.
2. Select “Transitions” from the drop-down menu:

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- a. Select the appropriate length (frames).
 - b. Select “Add” and choose the transition type from the menu.
3. Fade audio in-between clips by hovering over the white highlighted cut point between clips, then right-click to bring up the sequence pop-up menu:
 - Select “Transitions” from the drop-down menu, then click “Add Crossfade.”

Video Effects

1. Navigate to the “VFX” tab at the top of the screen:
 - As a default, 3 types of effects can be added to your clip on your timeline: 3D DVE (Digital Video Effects), Color Correction, and Titles.
2. To add effects to your sequence, drag the red time marker to the clip in your sequence that you would like to edit:
 - As you adjust the effects on the left panel, they will appear as a small, light-blue square in the left corner of your clip.

3D DVE (Digital Video Effects)

The 3D DVE provides a variety of tools that work to move images to any point imaginable. This can be done using the rotation, position, scale, crop, and shadow menus.

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The following will briefly describe how each tool can be used to manipulate your image:

Rotation

- Use the “X” dial to rotate images vertically.
- The “Y” dial will rotate images horizontally.
- The “Z” dial will rotate images forwards and backward.

Position

- The “X” slider can be dragged left or right to move images horizontally on the screen.
- The “Y” slider is used to move images horizontally.

Scale

- The “Master” slider is used to resize the image.
- Use the “X” to stretch or squeeze images horizontally.

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- Use the “Y” slider to stretch or squeeze images vertically.

Crop

- Use the “Y” slider to stretch or **squeeze images vertically**.

Shadow

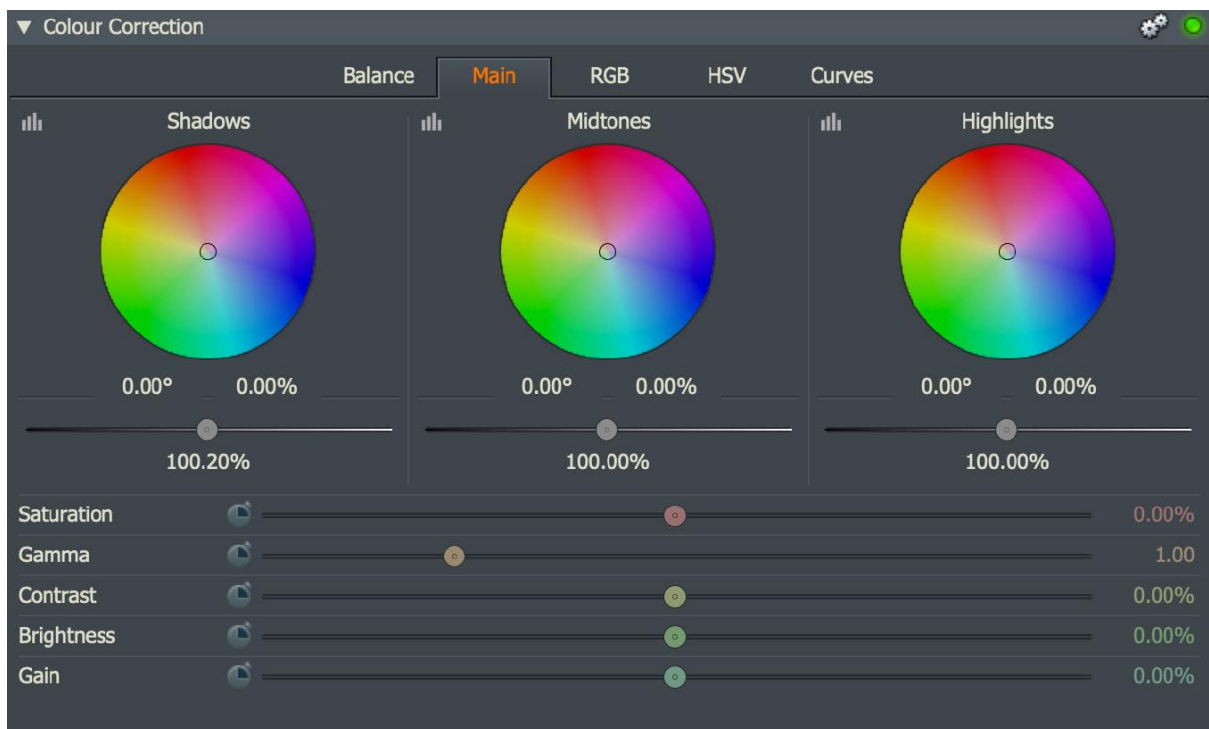
- Use the “edge softness” slider to add a vignette effect to the corners of your image.
- The “opacity” slider can be used to fade your image.

TIP: You can also adjust images by manipulating the size and position in the sequence viewer

Color Correction

While the number of possibilities is limitless with the color correction menu, this section will briefly describe how to use the panel to adjust the color of your image. The main panel is divided into five sections:

Balance, Main, RGB, HSV, and Curves; we will be discussing the “Main” tab.

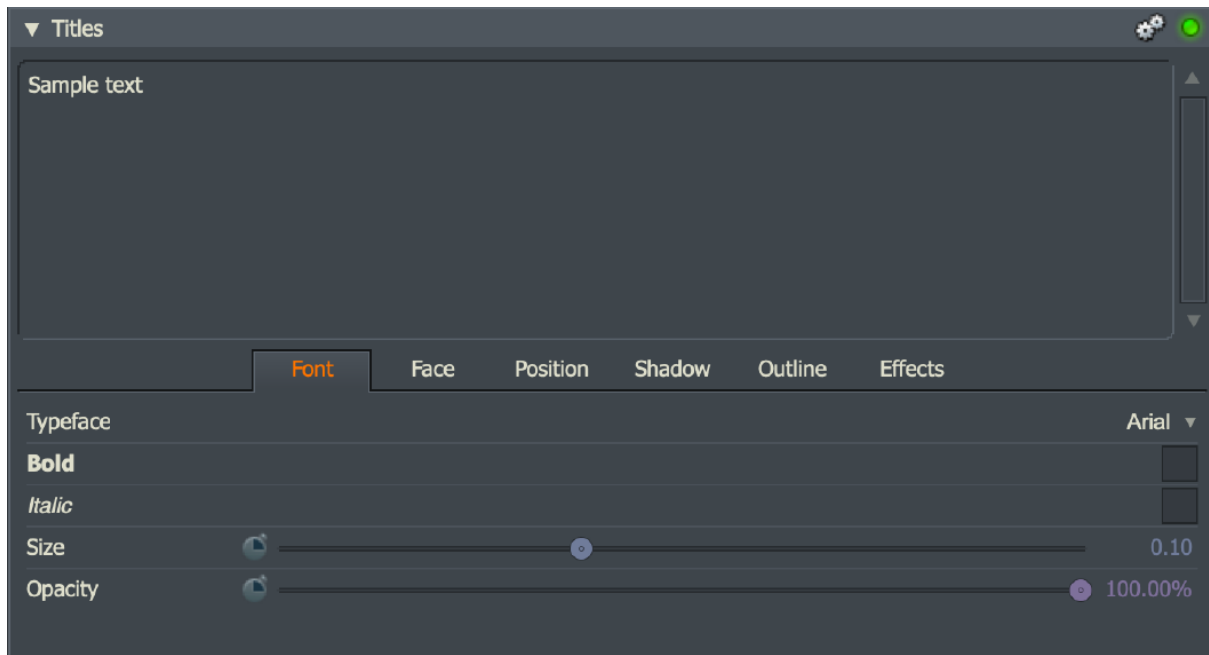


The “Main” tab features three color wheels that can be used to add color to the shadows, midtones, and highlights of your image; the knob at the bottom allows you to adjust the saturation of the color selection in the color wheel.

Titles

The titles feature can be added using one of three effects: Crawling titles, Rolling titles, and Static titles. This section will describe to add each title effect.

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1. To add a title, adjust the red time marker to the section where you'd like your title to appear.
2. Type your caption into the textbox in the top panel:
 - You can adjust the font, face, position, shadow, outline, and effects using the tabs below.
3. Adjust the title effects by navigating to the "position" tab.

TIP: Titles can be directly manipulated in the sequence viewer.

Static Titles

- Move the X and Y sliders to adjust the position of your title to the location you want.

Crawling Titles

- Adjust the "Spacing" slider to determine the space between captions.

Rolling Titles

- Adjust the "position" and "progress" sliders to set your title to the starting point.

Exporting content

You can directly upload your content to a YouTube or Vimeo account or you can export your video to a different format.

- To export your content, right-click in the sequence viewer panel. A pop-up menu will appear
- Select the "export" arrow and choose from one of the four targets: Blu-ray, DVD, Vimeo, and YouTube:

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- Once you've selected your export version, a pop-up box will appear.
- From here, we can adjust the frame rate, size, and even have content uploaded directly to your YouTube or Vimeo account.
- Select "Export the whole sequence" in the Region section, then click the start button.

Congratulations! Your content has been successfully exported and/or uploaded!